

TAKING CRITICISM

Whoever always defends himself does not make fewer mistakes, he just stops hearing about them.

How to listen without defending yourself and without closing the door.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

People keep seeing, they only stop telling.

THE CASCADE

The reflex that closes the door.



WHAT YOU SEE

The criticism lands and your body reacts before your head...



THE MECHANISM

...you explain the context the other person did not have...



THE CONSEQUENCE

...and he learns that talking to you is hard work.

You do not win the argument, you lose the next piece of information.

THE FORK

What your first sentence gives away.

YOUR FIRST LINE

01

Started with well, actually? That was defense.

02

Went silent and stiff? That was quiet punishment.

03

Started with a question? That was listening.

You do not have to agree on the spot. You have to let the information in.

THE METHOD

The 90 second rule.

01 **BREATHE**

first ten seconds, do not answer, the silence is awkward and protective

02 **ASK**

up to forty, a specific example, and listen without finishing the sentence

03 **REPEAT**

up to seventy, what you understood, in your own words

04 **BOOK**

up to ninety, thank them and set the follow up, you decide nothing now

Ninety seconds separate whoever grows from whoever only explains himself.

WHAT TO ASK, IN ORDER

What to say in place of a defense.

01 • BREATHE

Can you give me a specific example?

pulls the talk off the label and back onto the fact

02 • ASK

Let me check I understood, you are saying that...

shows listening and fixes misreadings with no argument

03 • REPEAT

What would you do in my seat?

turns the critic into a partner in the solution

04 • BOOK

Can I think about it and come back tomorrow?

legitimate, honest, and it avoids reacting in the heat

TWO MODELS

Two reactions, two futures.

THE COMMON MODEL

Defending

Explains the context on the spot

Hunts for the other person's error

Closes it fast and politely

Receives less criticism every time

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Receiving

Asks for an example

Separates the fact from the delivery

Closes with a follow up on the calendar

Hears the problem before it grows

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three reactions nobody forgets.

01 Hunting for who said it before dealing with what was said.

→ from then on the information vanishes and gossip takes its place.

02 Saying thanks with a closed body and changing the subject.

→ everyone reads that as do not bring me anything else.

03 Bringing the criticism back weeks later, as a grievance.

→ once that happens, nobody takes the risk again.

The team does not judge your reaction by the sentence, it judges what changes after.

THE CHAIN

The second critique test.

01

Someone criticized you once, and you took it well.



02

Three months went by with none at all.



03

It is not that you got everything right, the door closed.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

A long silence from the team is not praise, it is a diagnosis.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

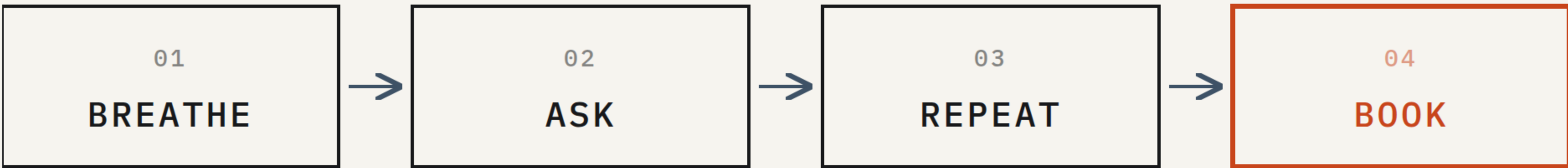
How to train the muscle this week.

		
STEP 01	STEP 02	STEP 03
Ask one person for a specific criticism about you.	In the moment, only ask and take notes, explain nothing.	Come back in a week and tell them what you changed.
a closed question works better, what exactly should I stop doing	the urge to clarify is exactly the muscle you are training	that return is what guarantees the next criticism

Criticism that produces visible change buys trust for months.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The 90 Second Rule, in the order that matters.



Whoever always defends himself does not err less. He only knows less.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

next time someone points out a flaw of yours.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA